

Edgar Placeholder Submissions — Root Cause & Remediation

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Date: 2026-09-13 · **Status:** Root cause confirmed, primary fix shipped, hardening pending

1. Executive summary

- **71 rows** on the *Telegram Chat Logs* tab carry **column G = `[No Text Provided]`**.
- All 71 are **`Edgar\_\*`** records with **column P = `no\_signature\_format`** — i.e. the DApp/Edgar API path received a **completely empty request body**.
- **No content was ever received by the server**, so nothing leaked and nothing was "lost in transit" — the submission never left the contributor's browser.
- The affected span is **2026-05-31 → 2026-09-12** — far wider than the recent iPhone report. The iOS 26 upload bug is **one cause**, not the only one.
- **Root cause (recent cluster):** iOS WebKit fails to transmit ``fetch`` + ``FormData`` + camera-``File`` bodies → empty body → Edgar records a placeholder.
- **Primary fix shipped and promoted to production** (see §5): ``dapp_beta`` PR #88 → ``dapp_prod``, verified live.
- **Recovery of the 71 rows is impossible** — and, for these rows, unnecessary: an empty body contains nothing to recover (§4).
- **Hardening still pending** (needs governor go): a **400-guard** on the submit endpoint so an empty body can never again be recorded as a silent "success".

2. What the 71 rows are

Enumerated directly via the Sheets API (`rows scanned: 12,399`):

Property	Finding
Count	71 (exact)
Column A (id)	all `Edgar_*` — DApp/API origin, not the Telegram webhook
Column P	all `no_signature_format`
Column G	all `[No Text Provided]`
Contributor / attachment / tx-hash / TDG	all empty (`H=Unknown`, `K=nil`, `Q`/`R` empty)
Device / browser stored	none (0 mentions across all 71 rows)

Distribution by month:

Month	Count
2026-05	2
2026-06	6
2026-07	5
2026-08	30
2026-09	28
Total	71

3. Root cause

The logic that proves it. In the submit handler:

```
> `Gdrive::TelegramRawLog.add_record( text.presence || '[No Text Provided]', ... , signature_verification )`
```

A blank `text` produces **both** `no\_signature\_format` **and** the `[No Text Provided]` placeholder. Therefore:

- **Placeholder ■ the server received an empty/absent `text` field.** There is no third case.

Why the body arrives empty (recent cluster). Every recent failure is **iPhone-exclusive** (iOS 26.6.1, Chrome/WebKit 152→153) and correlates with **camera JPEG** attachments — the well-documented WebKit `fetch` + `FormData` + file bug class. The one iPhone *success* carried a small saved PNG, not a camera capture.

Why nobody noticed. The form checked only `resp.ok` and reported success regardless, while Edgar returned **HTTP 200 even for an empty body** — so a failed submit looked identical to a good one.

4. Why the content cannot be recovered

Four candidate sources were checked; all are dead ends:

Source	Result
nginx `access.log`	Default format only — no `\$request_length` / `\$request_body`. Only the <i>response</i> size is logged (116 = empty body).
CloudWatch	`DescribeLogGroups` for `nginx` / `seni` / `dao*` → zero log groups .
Rails app log	Debug preview lines absent from every archive (0 hits); last file archive 27 Aug . Moot in any case — `dao/` is not served by Rails.

Source	Result
dao_protocol (real handler)	<code>`/dao/submit_contribution`</code> is served by the dao_protocol FastAPI service (:8010) , a host not reachable from the autopilot box , so its logs could not be inspected.

The honest conclusion: for these 71 rows, "recover what was submitted" is the wrong question — an empty body carries **no content**. There is **no way** to recover it, and **nothing material was lost**, because whatever was typed never left the device. No data exposure occurred.

5. The fix — shipped and promoted to production

Transport fix (``dapp_beta`` PR #88, merged; promoted to ``dapp_prod``):

File	Change
<code>`scripts/edgar_submission.js`</code> (new)	Multipart POST via XMLHttpRequest ; attachment materialised as an in-memory Blob ; bounded auto-retry ($\leq 3\times$) until Edgar confirms <code>`signature_verification === 'success'`</code> ; 4xx surfaced immediately (not retried).
<code>`report_contribution.html`</code> / <code>`report_dao_expenses.html`</code> / <code>`report_asset_receipt.html`</code>	Use the shared helper.
<code>`service-worker.js`</code>	Cache bumped v18 → v19 (+ precache).
<code>`tests/edgar-submission.test.js`</code> (new)	15 unit tests, wired into CI.

Verification:

- Beta test on the affected iPhone: **no empty-body (116) response after the fix**.
- Production verified **byte-identical** to the locally-tested build (git blob SHAs matched 7/7); CI **green**; live site confirmed serving the new helper.
- **No silent fallback:** after retries are exhausted the form surfaces a **hard error** (per governor instruction).

6. Recommendations (each requires governor go)

1. **Server 400-guard (highest priority).** ``submit_contribution`` should return **400** on blank text / missing signature format, instead of 200 + a placeholder row. This is the only change that makes an empty submission **impossible to record as success**, and it makes the client retry **verifiable**.
2. **Byte-level logging (diagnostic).** Add ``$request_length $content_length`` to the edge nginx ``log_format``, so any future empty POST is **provable at the byte level** rather than inferred from a response fingerprint.
3. **Housekeeping.** The 71 rows carry no content and had **no TDG effect**; they can be annotated or deleted (sheet version history makes this reversible).

7. Bottom line

The 71 placeholders are **silent empty-body submissions**, not corrupted records — the content never reached the server, so there is nothing to recover and **no data was exposed**. The **primary iOS transport fix is live in production**; the remaining work is **hardening** (the 400-guard) so that this failure mode can never again pass as success.

Sources: Telegram Chat Logs tab (Sheets API, 12,399 rows scanned); seni_ror nginx + journald; CloudWatch DescribeLogGroups; dao_controller.rb submit handler; dapp_beta PR #88 and dapp_prod sync record.